

T-storm 89/73 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 94/76 B18

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, AUGUST 16, 2025 • \$4

Smith to remain chief as judge holds off federal control of D.C. police

Pushback on takeover, but mandate to cooperate with ICE likely to stand

BY MEAGAN FLYNN, SALVADOR RIZZO, JEREMY ROEBUCK AND OLIVIA GEORGE

A federal judge persuaded the Justice Department to walk back President Donald Trump's efforts to assert control over the D.C. police department, but said Trump probably could enlist officers to help enforce immigration laws — signaling that the president's effort to exert unprecedented command over law enforcement in the nation's capital may continue.

After hearing arguments Friday on an emergency request from D.C. officials to block the Trump administration's takeover of the city's 3,100-member police department, U.S. District Judge Ana C. Reyes forged a compromise of sorts between the two sides — without issuing a ruling — on the key question of who runs

the police force. She indicated D.C. Police Chief Pamela A. Smith has to remain in charge.

The court did not rule on another crucial question: whether Trump can commandeer D.C. police officers to enforce immigration laws. That issue is likely to be resolved next week, Reyes said — but the Trump administration probably would be able to require help on immigration matters from local officers.

The D.C. government could once again face a dilemma: comply with the Trump administration's efforts to enforce immigration law, despite District laws and policies preventing police from doing so, or resist and further inflame one of the greatest conflicts in the half-century history of the city's home rule.

The lawsuit sets up a major power clash in entirely untested territory as the District clings to its limited self-governance. It is the starkest illustration in three decades of the vast power the federal government retains over the nation's capital: The very law

SEE TAKEOVER ON A5

Rising fears: Clash over immigrant policies in D.C. chills residents. B13

Noem lives rent-free in home meant for Coast Guard leader

BY MARIANNE LEVINE, LIZ GOODWIN AND DAN LAMOTHE

Department of Homeland Security Secretary Kristi L. Noem is living for free in a military home typically reserved for the U.S. Coast Guard's top admiral, officials familiar with the matter said. The highly unusual arrangement has raised concern within the administration and from some Democrats, who describe it as a waste of military resources.

Noem recently moved into Quarters 1, a spacious waterfront residence at Joint Base Anacostia-Bolling in Washington where the Coast Guard commandant typically resides. She did so because of concerns over her safety after the Daily Mail, a British tabloid, published photographs in April of the area around Noem's residence in Washington's Navy Yard neighborhood, DHS spokeswoman Tricia McLaughlin said.

McLaughlin described Noem's time at the commandant's residence as temporary. She did not specify how long the setup would

last or how long Noem has lived there.

Noem pays no rent to live in the commandant's house, according to an official familiar with the matter who, like others, spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitivity of the situation. That's a departure from how other Cabinet secretaries have handled similar arrangements. Other Cabinet officials, including during both Trump administrations, have paid to use military housing that otherwise would be occupied by top generals and admirals.

Noem's housing has raised eyebrows among current and retired Coast Guard officials, as well as Democrats, who warn that Noem risks creating the perception that she is exploiting the perks of her position as DHS secretary, in which she supervises the Coast Guard. They say her decision could set off a chain reaction that could displace other senior members of the service in a situation

SEE NOEM ON A18

Trump stocks: Apple, Nvidia in his portfolio in area he influences. A13

No deal as summit wraps early



ANDREW HARNIK/GETTY IMAGES

President Donald Trump walks with Russian President Vladimir Putin on Friday in Anchorage, Alaska, before their high-stakes meeting.



ED RAM/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A Ukrainian machine gun operator prepares to take infantry soldiers to a frontline position north of the key city of Pokrovsk.

Kyiv races to reclaim land lost in war, lest U.S. demand even more for peace

BY SIOBHÁN O'GRADY AND SERHII KOROLCHUK

DONETSK REGION, UKRAINE — Ukrainian troops were racing to claw back a key stretch of land on the eastern front after a surprise Russian advance bolstered Moscow's position as President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin met in Alaska.

SEE UKRAINE ON A10

Ukraine rushed elite troops to try to seal the disastrous breach after small groups of Russian foot soldiers exploited weak points on Ukraine's flanks and pushed more than nine miles toward the eastern city of Dobro-pillya in rapid gains that threaten the security of the entire contested region.

TRUMP HOSTS PUTIN IN UKRAINE WAR TALKS

Leaders take no questions, say little about progress

BY MICHAEL BIRNBAUM, CAT ZAKRZEWSKI, FRANCESCA EBEL AND CATHERINE BELTON

ANCHORAGE — President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin broke off a high-stakes meeting on Friday that aimed to end the bloodiest European war since World War II in a historic visit that boosted the Russian leader but did not immediately deliver the peace in Ukraine Trump so hotly seeks.

The two leaders said they had made progress, but they offered no details in a brief appearance with reporters. Putin seized the moment to deliver a bristling history lesson about the “root causes” of the conflict in Ukraine — code for demilitarizing the country and blocking its entry to NATO — as Trump stood at his side. It was a sign of the Russian leader's continuing unwillingness to make concessions in his long quest to neutralize Kyiv's efforts to stand free as a sovereign nation — and of the limitations so far of Trump's diplomacy-by-flattery playbook.

It was a good day for Putin, who came in from the cold to be treated to a B-2 stealth bomber flyover, a brief ride in Trump's armored limousine and a chance to show his own people that he was received as a peer by the world's most powerful man. Russian state media gleefully replayed clips of the red-carpet reception and contrasted it with Trump's fiery handling of Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy in February, when he booted the leader from the White House.

Trump told reporters that he would brief European leaders and Zelenskyy about the talks, but that “there's no deal until there's a deal.” The president, who usually relishes thrust-and-parry with journalists, took no questions — a rare moment of restraint that was a measure of a meeting that likely yielded nothing immediately positive to report.

“We had an extremely productive meeting, and many points were agreed to,” Trump said. “There are just a very few that are left. Some are not that significant.”

SEE SUMMIT ON A12

ICE files reveal plans for breakneck growth in detention space

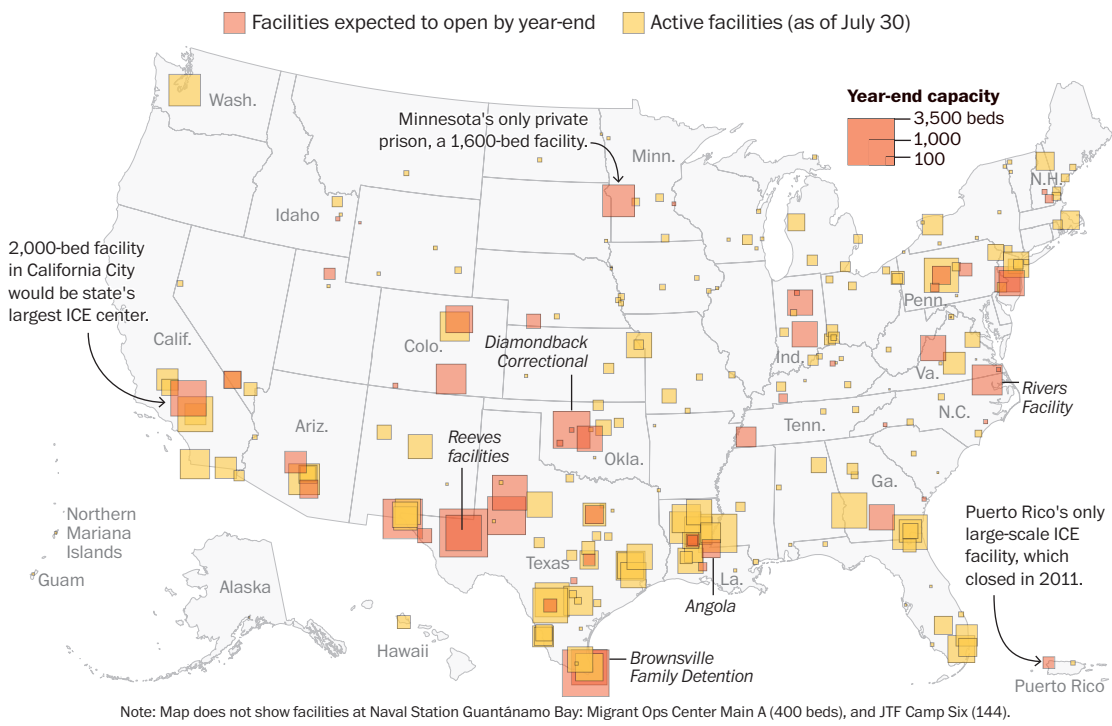
Agency aims to double the number of beds, including for families

BY DOUGLAS MACMILLAN, N. KIRKPATRICK AND LYDIA SIDHOM

When President Donald Trump took office this year, the United States already commanded the largest immigrant detention system in the world, with the capacity to hold close to 50,000 migrants. Right away, his administration set a goal of doubling it.

An internal planning road map obtained by The Washington Post shows for the first time exactly how immigration authorities plan to reach that goal, including by opening or expanding 125 facilities this year. By January, ICE will have the capacity to hold more than 107,000 people, internal

SEE ICE ON A6



U.S. position helps sink talks on treaty to rein in plastics

BY CHICO HARLAN

GENEVA — After spurning other global environmental efforts, the United States showed up in force in Switzerland for landmark plastic treaty talks — seeking a deal, the Trump administration said, but opposing the production limits that many other nations saw as the main solution.

That position was just one of the many factors that helped sink the talks, which broke apart early Friday morning after 11 tense days and left the multiyear attempt to curb the world's plastic pollution at an impasse.

Though the countries in attendance had hoped to strike the most important environmental treaty since the Paris agreement, they instead wound up fighting over contradictory red lines as a draft text was endlessly revised,

never coming even close to an agreement.

Some participants, before heading home, said they could see faint signs of progress. But others questioned whether the consensus-based international system — increasingly shaped by the zero-sum negotiating approach of President Donald Trump — could weather entrenched divides and lead to a deal.

“In the current political circumstances, it's really tough,” said Ian Fry, a negotiator from the Pacific island of Tuvalu. Speaking about the U.S., he said there was “not a lot of room for them to move” and added, “It's unprecedented, this intransigence.”

As the talks broke up, Kate Lynch, Australia's lead negotiator, told other countries that

SEE TREATY ON A8

IN THE NEWS

‘MAHA’ plan leaked A draft report about improving the health of children took aim at ultra-processed foods and chemical exposure but avoided a crackdown some had feared. A2

Redistricting battles The House speaker is in a bind trying to placate GOP members fearful of blowback while also backing Trump. A4

THE NATION **Texas GOP** leaders sought to maximize pain and punishment on absent lawmakers. A3 **The Kennedy Center** dropped the family that has handcrafted medals for over 47 years. A6

THE WORLD **Thailand** is working furiously to close tariff loopholes as the U.S. aims to thwart China. A9 **A soccer star's** post kindled curiosity about the killing of the “Palestinian Pelé” in Gaza. A12

THE ECONOMY **Treasury Secretary** Scott Bessent ousted three more IRS executives as the tax agency experiences unprecedented turnover. A13 **Brands are hoping** that elevating high-quality products will keep sales steady as tariffs spur price hikes. A14

STYLE **To increase** their chances of being selected for a sorority, college women are turning to rush coaches. B1

SPORTS **Michigan** was dealt hefty fines and penalties by the NCAA for stealing signs during its 2023 title season. B7

THE REGION **The Education Department** will pull funding from five Virginia school districts that won't change their transgender policies. B13 **The future** of a massive data center in Prince William is in doubt after a ruling voided it, but an appeal is planned. B13

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